



HIS GLOBAL CONCLAVE
UNITED NATIONS ENVIRONMENT PROGRAMME
UNEP BACKGROUND GUIDE

TOPICS:

Topic 1: Global Carbon Emission Reduction

Topic 2: Financing Climate Action

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SECTION I | LETTER FROM THE SECRETARIAT

Greetings Delegates!!!

On behalf of the Secretariat, we are thrilled to welcome you to the 1st Edition of the HIS Global Conclave. This event promises to be an enriching experience that will leave a lasting impression. The Conclave aims to showcase your creativity, diplomacy, and problem-solving skills as you engage in discussions around global challenges.

This is not just a simulation, but a unique gathering of bright minds from diverse backgrounds, tackling pressing issues with a focus on the Sustainable Development Goals. Our six esteemed committees are designed to address problems not commonly explored in other MUNs, and we eagerly anticipate your innovative solutions.

Beyond debates, the Conclave offers a platform to display your public-speaking, networking, and leadership skills while experiencing the richness of cultures from around the world. Active participation is key to making your committee a success and truly embracing the spirit of being a "MUNner."

We at HIS appreciate the enthusiasm students bring to international diplomacy, and we have worked diligently to ensure a seamless experience for all. Your involvement is the first step toward shaping the next generation of world leaders.

We can't wait to meet you all on November 15th for what promises to be productive and engaging discussions!

Warm regards,

Akhil Gokul

Secretary General

Rehan Saied

Deputy Secretary General

SECTION II | LETTER FROM THE EB

Dear Delegates,

On behalf of the UNEP committee, we hope this letter finds you well. It is with great pleasure that we welcome you to the **Hindustan International School Global Conclave (HISGC) 2024!** We are excited to serve as your Chair and Vice Chairs for this year's UNEP committee and eagerly anticipate seeing your commitment to environmental diplomacy, innovation, and solution-building on November 15.

This year's topics are:

1. **Global Carbon Emission Reductions**
2. **Financing Climate Action**

These issues were selected to challenge your perspectives and inspire thoughtful discussions on sustainable development and environmental protection. As we address global climate challenges, your contributions will play a critical role in crafting meaningful strategies for environmental resilience and sustainability.

Your expertise and collaboration in this committee will be invaluable, and we encourage you to bring forward bold ideas and work closely with fellow delegates to devise impactful solutions. Please know that the Executive Board is here to support you at every step.

Once again, welcome to HISGC 2024. We look forward to meeting each of you and witnessing your commitment to a greener, more sustainable future.

Please be assured that the committee EB members are here to support you.

Sincerely,

Chair- Kavya Vijay

Vice Chair- Aprajith.S

SECTION III | HISTORY OF THE COMMITTEE

The **United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)** was established in 1972 as the leading global authority on environmental issues, born from the landmark **United Nations Conference on the Human Environment in Stockholm**. Recognizing the growing need for international cooperation to address environmental degradation, **UNEP** was created to guide and coordinate global efforts toward **environmental sustainability, conservation, and the protection of natural resources**.

UNEP's mandate includes assessing global environmental conditions, promoting sustainable development, and encouraging nations to implement environmentally sound policies. Over the years, UNEP has spearheaded pivotal initiatives such as the Montreal Protocol to protect the ozone layer, the Convention on Biological Diversity, and the Paris Agreement on climate change, all of which have shaped international environmental standards and policies.

Today, UNEP faces evolving challenges like climate change, biodiversity loss, and pollution. The organization remains committed to adapting its strategies to address these pressing issues, promoting sustainable solutions that uphold environmental integrity and contribute to a healthier, more resilient world.

SECTION IV | INTRODUCTION TO THE AGENDA

Topic 1: Global Carbon Emission Reductions

Reducing global carbon emissions is crucial for mitigating climate change and its far-reaching impacts on the planet. The increasing levels of greenhouse gases necessitate immediate action to prevent catastrophic environmental consequences. This agenda advocates for international cooperation in implementing effective carbon reduction strategies, including the transition to renewable energy, enhancing energy efficiency, and promoting sustainable practices across all sectors. By setting ambitious yet attainable targets, countries can collectively strive to limit global warming, protect ecosystems, and foster a sustainable future.

Topic 2: Financing Climate Action

Financing climate action is vital for supporting initiatives that address climate change and promote sustainability. Adequate funding enables nations, particularly those with limited resources, to implement necessary mitigation and adaptation measures. This agenda emphasizes the need for innovative financing solutions, such as green investments, climate funds, and partnerships, to mobilize resources effectively. Aligning financial flows with climate goals ensures that investments contribute to emission reductions and sustainable development, ultimately fostering resilience and safeguarding the environment for future generations.

SECTION V | KEY TREATIES AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) - Adopted on May 22, 1992

Aims to conserve biological diversity, promote sustainable use of its components, and ensure fair sharing of benefits arising from genetic resources.

- **United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC)** -
Adopted on May 9, 1992
Establishes a framework for international cooperation to combat climate change and its impacts, setting the stage for subsequent agreements like the Kyoto Protocol and Paris Agreement.
- **Kyoto Protocol** - Adopted on December 11, 1997
A legally binding agreement that commits its parties to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, based on the premise that global warming exists and human-made CO₂ emissions have caused it.
- **Paris Agreement** - Adopted on December 12, 2015
An international treaty that aims to limit global warming to well below 2 degrees Celsius, with efforts to limit the temperature increase to 1.5 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels.
- **Stockholm Convention on Persistent Organic Pollutants** - Adopted on May 22, 2001
Aims to eliminate or restrict the production and use of persistent organic pollutants (POPs), harmful chemicals that remain in the environment for long periods.
- **Basel Convention on the Control of Transboundary Movements of Hazardous Wastes and Their Disposal** - Adopted on March 22, 1989
Regulates the international trade and disposal of hazardous waste to protect human health and the environment.
- **Ramsar Convention on Wetlands** - Adopted on February 2, 1971
Focuses on the conservation and sustainable use of wetlands, recognizing their ecological importance.

Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer - Adopted on September 16, 1987 An international treaty designed to phase out the production and consumption of substances responsible for ozone depletion.

SECTION VI | IMPORTANT EVENTS

Establishment of **UNEP (1972)**: UNEP was established during the United Nations Conference on the Human Environment held in Stockholm, Sweden, from June 5 to 16, 1972. It marked the first major international gathering to address environmental issues and laid the foundation for global environmental governance.

1. First **Global Environmental Outlook Report (1997)**: UNEP published its first Global Environmental Outlook (GEO) report in 1997, providing an integrated assessment of the state of the global environment. This report set a precedent for future assessments and highlighted critical environmental challenges.
2. Rio **Earth Summit (1992)**: The United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED), also known as the Rio Earth Summit, took place in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, from June 3 to 14, 1992. It produced key documents such as Agenda 21 and the Rio Declaration, which emphasized sustainable development and the role of UNEP in promoting it.
3. Kyoto **Protocol Adoption (1997)**: On December 11, 1997, the Kyoto Protocol was adopted during the third session of the Conference of the Parties to the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) in Kyoto, Japan. UNEP played a crucial role in supporting climate action and promoting the protocol's implementation.
4. Establishment of the **Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services (IPBES) (2012)**: In April 2012, the IPBES was established to strengthen the science-policy interface for biodiversity and ecosystem services. UNEP was instrumental in facilitating

its creation, addressing the need for informed decision-making in biodiversity conservation.

5. **UN Environment Assembly (2014):** The first UN Environment Assembly (UNEA) was convened in Nairobi, Kenya, from June 23 to 27, 2014. UNEA serves as the world's highest-level decision-making body on the environment and provides a platform for addressing global environmental challenges.
 6. **Paris Agreement (2015):** The Paris Agreement, adopted on December 12, 2015, at the 21st Conference of the Parties to the UNFCCC in Paris, France, represents a landmark global commitment to combat climate change. UNEP has been involved in supporting countries in implementing their climate goals and enhancing ambition. UNEP's Emissions Gap Report (annual since 2010): UNEP began publishing the Emissions Gap Report in 2010, which assesses the gap between projected greenhouse gas emissions and the levels required to limit global warming. This annual report has become an essential tool for policymakers in climate action planning and ambition enhancement.
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SECTION VII | CLOSING REMARKS

As delegates of the first Hindustan International School Global Conclave, you are responsible for representing your country, doing proper research on the above topics. This session presents you with the opportunity to showcase your debating abilities, diplomacy, critical and analytical skills and the ability to collaborate with other delegates

Good luck delegates!!

Regards,
The UNEP Executive Board.

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